

Cobb Lecture Hall

D21



[If you have comments, send additional information](#)

Address: 5811-27 South Ellis Avenue

Year Construction: 1892

Year Acquired: 1892

Architect: Henry Ives Cobb

Gross Square Feet: 83,739

Primary Use: Teaching

Design Zone: Main Quadrangle

Last Major Renovation:

1966 gut/renovation; piecemeal

Comments:

Oldest building on campus. 1966 gut/renovation by Burnham & Hammond; piecemeal reconfigurations and renovations since then.

REGULATORY STATUS

National Register: Not individually listed

NR Historic District:

Hyde Park-Kenwood Historic District

Chicago HRS Color Code: Orange

1 - Site

Land Ownership Status: Owned

Location - Physical:

Location - Program Adjacency:

Connected at basement and first floor levels to Blake Hall.

Location Comment:

Forms northern terminus of connected Blake/Gates/Goodspeed buildings. Original campus building with entrance onto main quad rather than Ellis Avenue.

2 - Adaptability

Construction Type:

Reinforced concrete construction

Accessibility:

Entrance - Y; Bathrooms - P

Floor-to-Floor Height:

1st: 14'-2", 2nd, 3rd: 13'-10", 4th: 11'-11"

Structural Capability:

Adaptable subject to structural analysis. Building has received substantial structural modification.

Adaptability Exterior:

Building exterior masonry facade is substantially intact and is a signature presence. Adaptation should consider this context.

Adaptability Interior:

Interior has been completely renovated from original - highly adaptable for offices and classrooms.

Adaptability Physical Features:

Original masonry exterior substantially intact. Class gift of exterior clock on east facade.

Adaptability Structure:

Adaptable within constraints of construction type.

3 - Building Envelope

Roof Type: Clay Tile (2006)

Exterior Facade:

Limestone

Exterior Base: Limestone

Exterior Trim: Limestone

4 - Heritage and Historic

Landmark Status:

no

National Register: Not individually listed

NR Historic District:

Hyde Park-Kenwood Historic District

NR Comments:

Historical and architectural significance equally, item #119 on district nomination form

CHRS Comments:

Possesses potentially significant architectural or historical significance

Heritage - Exterior:

The masonry facade is substantially intact and features a distinctive clock face on the main quad front.

Heritage - Interior:

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Virtually no original interior finishes or room configurations still exist. The top floor Renaissance Society gallery space features exposed roof construction.

Significant Spaces Identified:

No Comment

Heritage Culture Elements:

Cobb Hall is the original classroom/office building on the main quad and has been reconfigured and renovated numerous times.

Architectural Awards Certification:

None identified

Heritage and History - General Comments:

Iconic presence of original university classroom/office building with completely transformed interior.

5 - Sustainability

Certifications:

none identified

Window Last Replacement:**Weather Stripping:**

not identified

R Value Roof/Wall:

not identified

Systems:**Deficiencies:**